GoPiGo3 Getting Started with Buster

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GoPiGo3 with Raspberry Pi OS Buster MicroSD Card

Purpose: Download and install Raspberry Pi OS Buster.

NOTE: The default username and password for a Raspberry Pi:
Username: **pi** Password: **raspberry**

Raspbian is Linux: All commands in **Raspbian** are **case sensitive**

NOTE: Remove all USB drives from computer except the MicroSD adapter.

1. Insert a MicroSD adapter with a minimum 8 GB MicroSD card into a USB port on your computer.
2. Download and install the **Raspberry Pi Imager**
   https://www.raspberrypi.org/blog/raspberry-pi-imager-imaging-utility
3. Click **CHOOSE OS** →
   Raspberry Pi OS (other) →
   Raspberry Pi OS (Legacy) A port of Debian Buster with Security updates and desktop environment
4. Click **CHOOSE STORAGE → TS-RDF5 SD Transcend** (or whatever device has the MicroSD card)
   a. Click the Gear icon in the lower right side.
      i. **Enable SSH**
      ii. **Set username and password**
      iii. **Configure wireless LAN**
      iv. Click **SAVE**
   b. **Write:** Write the image
   c. When prompted: Remove the Transcend adapter.

Boot the GoPiGo3 Setup Raspberry Pi OS

1. Power off the GoPiGo3.
2. Insert the MicroSD card in the Raspberry Pi.
3. Power up the GoPiGo3. This will take a little longer the first time you boot the robot.

NOTE: There are a couple of ways to find the GoPiGo3's IP address. Note the IP address, you will need it to connect with SSH.

Network Scanner Method

Plug in a raspberry pi compatible wireless card.

- Advanced IP Scanner - https://www.advanced-ip-scanner.com
- Use ZenMap with Quick Scan setting www.nmap.org

NOTE: If raspberrypi does not show up in your network scan. You may need to press the on off button on the red board to shut it down. Be patient when you press the on off button. It takes a bit to shut down. Power off the battery. Power it up again to connect to your wireless network. Note the IP address.

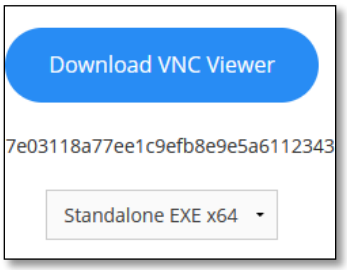
Keyboard, Mouse, Monitor

- Connect a keyboard, mouse and monitor to the GoPiGo3. Connect to or point to the wireless connection. You want to find the IP address.

4. Go to https://www.chiark.greenend.org.uk/~sgtatham/putty/latest.html
5. Download the **PuTTY** client.
6. Start the **PuTTY** client. Type in the **IP address** of the GiPiGo3 → Click **Open**.
7. **Accept** the **PuTTY Security Alert**.
8. Login as: **pi** Password: **raspberry**
9. Type: **sudo raspi-config**
10. Select **Interface Options → VNC** → Select **Yes.**
11. Exit the **raspi-config** interface.
12. Type: **sudo poweroff**

RealVNC Viewer

RealVNC viewer allows us to remotely control the GoPiGo3 in headless mode.



1. Go to https://www.realvnc.com/en/connect/download/viewer/
2. Download the VNC Viewer Standalone EXE anywhere you want to run the program from. You don't have to install it.

Setup Raspberry Pi OS

1. Power up the GoPiG3.
2. Double Click **VNC Viewer**.
3. Type in the IP address of your robot → Click **Connect**.
4. Click **Next** on the **Welcome to Raspberry Pi** welcome screen.
5. Set Country: **United States**
6. Timezone: **Denver**.
7. Check **Use English Language** and **Use US Keyboard**. Click **Next**.
8. **Change Password**: **(Create a memorable password)** → Click **Next**. (This will be your new pi and RealVNC password.)
9. **Set Up Screen**. Click **Next**.
10. **Setup Wifi Network**. Click **Skip**. (You are already connected.)
11. **Update Software**: Click **Next**. (This will take a while.)
12. Reboot the pi.

VNC Display Options

1. Raspberry Pi menu → **Preferences** → **Raspberry Pi Configuration**
2. **Display** tab → **Set Resolution** → **1280x1024**
3. Click **OK** → Close the Window
4. Click **Reboot** when prompted.

Setting up a Gmail Account for Email

If you don't have a Gmail account, you will want to create one.

Let's enable your Gmail account to receive connections from external programs, like Python.

1. Open your browser and access your Gmail account.
2. On the login screen → enter your Gmail username and password.

3. After the login → access the following URL:
   https://myaccount.google.com/signinoptions/two-step-verification

4. Enable the two-step verification on this account.

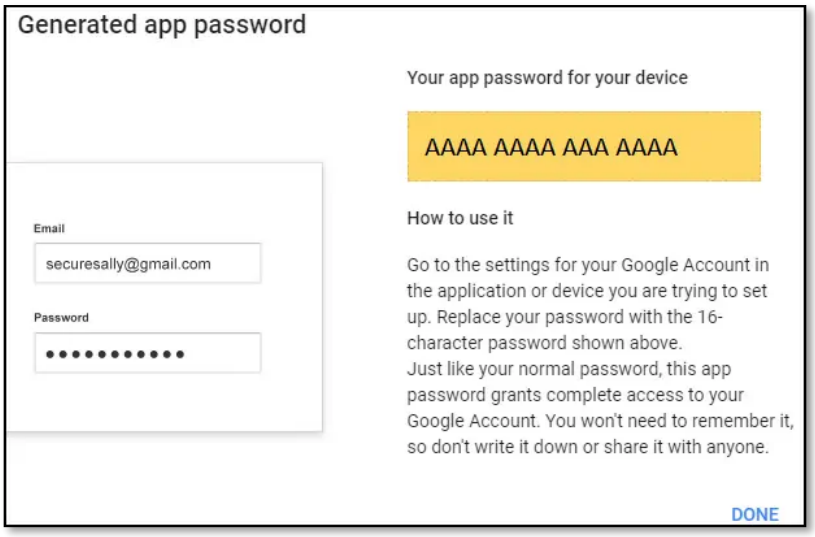
Create an Application Password

1. Access the following URL:
   https://security.google.com/settings/security/apppasswords

2. Select Gmail application and the type of device: **Other**.

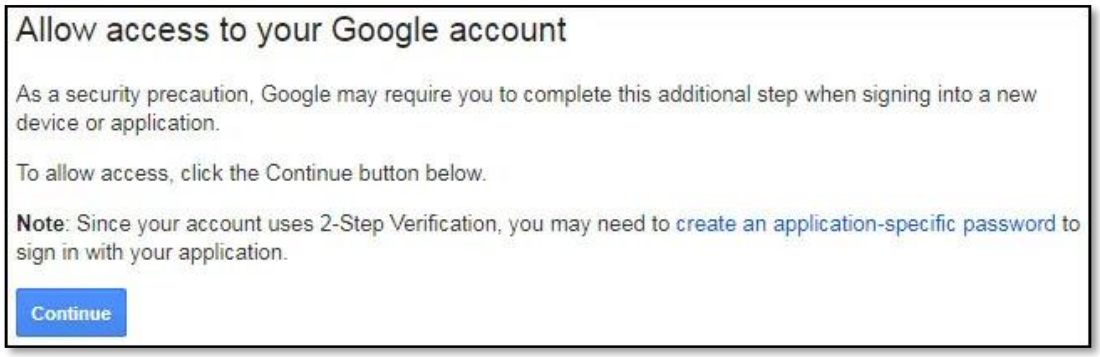
3. Name the device: **Python**

4. Click on the Generate button and take note of the randomly generated password.



5. Access the following URL:

6. https://accounts.google.com/DisplayUnlockCaptcha
7. Click on the **Continue** button to enable external access to your Google account.



You have finished the required steps for the Gmail integration.

Email IP Address on Startup

We want our GoPiGo3 to email us it's IP address on startup.

Complete the following steps on the GoPiGo3 desktop.

1. Create a folder to store your Python programs. **/home/pi/Code/**
2. Use the Web Browser on the upper right side to go to https://github.com/itinstructor/WNCCNASA
3. Logon with your GitHub account.
4. Go to **Code** → **Download ZIP**.
5. The file will download quickly. On the lower left side of the browser → Right Click on the file → **Open in Folder**.
6. Right Click the Zip file → **Extract Here**.
7. Right Click **startup_mailer.py → Copy.**
8. Paste startup_mailer.py into your Code folder
9. Right Click on **startup_mailer.py** → **Geany**
10. Change the **EMAIL_DESTINATION** email address to your own email address.
11. Change **EMAIL_SOURCE** and **EMAIL_PASSWORD** to your Gmail account information.

12. Save the file.
13. Open a terminal.
14. Type in the following to make the script executable.

```
sudo chmod 755 /home/pi/Code/startup_mailer.py
```

15. There should not be any errors if the command was successful.
16. Test the script with the following command.

```
python3 /home/pi/Code/startup_mailer.py
```

17. In a few moments, you should receive an email with your GoPiGo3 IP address.

Run startup_mailer.py Script on Startup

1. At the terminal, type in the following command to access the Raspbian scheduler. (Don't add sudo)

```
crontab -e
```

2. Press **Enter** to edit the file with nano.
3. Cursor to the bottom of the file. (The mouse will not work.)
4. Enter the following information. (sleep 15 waits 15 seconds after startup to run the script.)

```
@reboot sleep 15 && python3 /home/pi/Code/startup_mailer.py
```

5. Type **CTRL+S** to Save the file.
6. Press **CTRL+X** to Exit nano.
7. Type **sudo reboot**
8. You should receive an email with your IP address.

Setup or Update GoPiG3 Software

1. At the terminal, type the following commands without sudo. The libraries will install properly only if installed as the pi user. Installing the GoPiG3 software will take some time.

```
curl -kL dexterindustries.com/update_gopigo3 | bash
curl -kL dexterindustries.com/update_sensors | bash
```

2. Reboot the Raspberry Pi to make the settings take effect: **sudo reboot**

NOTE: Active development on this software has ended. There are still bug fixes released. You will want to occasionally check for updates the GoPiGo3 software.

Update Raspberry Pi OS

It is a good idea to update the Raspberry Pi OS on a regular basis.

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt dist-upgrade
```

Multiple Wireless SSID's

If you are using the GoPiGo3 on multiple wireless networks, edit the following file as shown. This command uses nano, a simple text editor built into the operating system.

```
sudo nano /etc/wpa_supplicant/wpa_supplicant.conf
```

The following is an example of adding WNCC-Internet to your wireless networks.

```
country=US
ctrl_interface=DIR=/var/run/wpa_supplicant GROUP=netdev
update_config=1


network={
    ssid="network_one_here"
    psk="wpa_password"
    id_str="home"
}


network={
    ssid="WNCC-Internet"
    key_mgmt=NONE
    id_str="school"
}
```

1. **CTRL+O** (Writes the file)
2. **Enter** to finish saving the file.
3. **CTRL+X** (Exit nano)

The pi will automatically connect to whichever wireless network is closer and has better signal. You can add as many wireless networks to this file as you wish.

Set 12-Hour Clock

To change the clock from military time to 12 hour time:

1. Right Click on the clock on the right hand side of the toolbar → **Digital Clock Settings.**
2. Change Clock Format to: **`%I:%M %p %x`**
    a. **%I:%M** = Hours Minutes
    b. **%p** = AM PM
    c. **%x** = current date
3. Click OK.

Set Interfaces

1. Go to the Raspberry icon on the left side of the toolbar.
2. **Preferences** → **Configuration** → **Raspberry Pi Configuration**.
3. Click **Interfaces**
    a. Enable Camera, SSH, SPI, I2C
4. Click OK. Click Yes to Reboot.

Set Desktop Shortcuts to Open Without Prompt with Buster

In **File Manager** → **Edit** → **Preferences** → Check **Don't ask options on launch executable file**

Disable Onboard Wi-Fi

Any external Wi-Fi antenna will have better signal strength and range. To use an external Wi-Fi antenna only, disable the internal Wi-Fi.

```
# Edit this file with nano
sudo nano /boot/config.txt
# Add this line to the file and save it
dtoverlay=pi3-disable-wifi
```

After you have disabled the on board Wi-Fi, you must always plug a Wi-Fi adapter into a USB port.

Wi-Fi Signal Strength

The **iwconfig** command will give you a snapshot of Wi-Fi quality.

wavemon will monitor Wi-Fi signal strength in real time.

```
# Install wavemon
sudo apt install wavemon -y
# Run wavemon
wavemon
# Quit wavemon
q
```

Signal Strength

The higher the signal strength, the more reliable the connection and higher speeds are possible. The signal strength is specified as -dBm (decibels related to one milliwatt).

Values between 0 and -100 are possible, with more being better. -51 dBm is a better signal strength than -60 dBm.

The value 0 is not realistic. Even -30 dBm is hard to reach, and you have to stand almost directly next to the access point.

Some guidance on how to read the results:

- 50 dBm is considered an excellent signal strength.
- 67 dBm is said to be the minimum signal strength for reliable and relatively fast packet delivery.
- 70 dBm is the minimum signal strength for reliable packet delivery.
- The minimum value for a basic connection is -80 dBm. However, packet delivery is no longer necessarily reliable.
- 90 dBm is already very close to the basic noise. Here a connection probably does not work anymore.

Link Quality

A network can have very good signal strength without good link quality.

This is how much of the data you send and receive will make it to the destination in good condition.

The quality indicator includes data like Bit Error Rate (BER), i.e., the number of bit errors in received bits that have been altered due to noise, interference, distortion, or bit synchronization errors. Others are Signal-to-Noise and Distortion Ratio (SINAD).

It is measured in percentage or on a scale of up to 70. So you will see a value like "60/70".

Unlike signal strength, it is somewhat harder to say which values are still considered to be ok.

If the value is low and your signal strength is high, you may have interference from, e.g., kitchen appliances or other electronic devices. Moving them further away may improve the link quality.

Frequency

Another interesting indicator is the Wi-Fi frequency.

This shows if your Raspberry Pi connects to the slower and longer range 2.4 GHz network, or the faster but shorter range 5 GHz version, provided, of course, that your router offers both networks.

Visual Studio Code

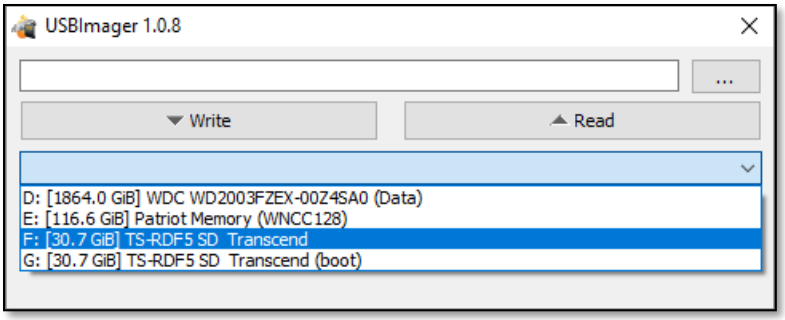
Visual Studio Code is available on the Raspberry Pi.

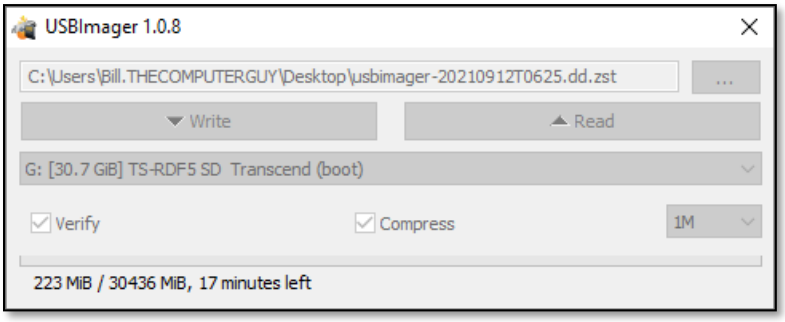
```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install code
```

Backup GoPiGo3 to a File Image

Things go wrong. It is a good idea to back up your MicroSD card to a file image at this point and any point prior to making big changes.

1. Go to https://gitlab.com/bztsrc/usbimager
2. Download the windows GDI version.
3. This is a portable program, there is not an installation, the program runs from wherever you put it.
4. Click the downward pointing triangle as shown to select your MicroSD card. The card will show 2 partitions, it doesn't matter which one you choose, the entire card will be backup up to a file image.



5. Click **Compress**.

6. Click **Read**. The program will automatically create a compressed backup file of approximately 5GB on your Desktop.